W2 · The Alphabet Tree

Nivel Básico A2 · Unit 1 · The alphabet: letter sounds and spelling

1 The alphabet. Listen and repeat. Look at the vowel sound of each letter.

A /eɪ/	**B** /biː/	**C** /siː/	**D** /diː/	**E** /iː/	**F** /ef/
G /dʒiː/	**H** /eɪtʃ/	**I** /aɪ/	**J** /dʒeɪ/	**K** /keɪ/	**L** /el/
M /em/	**N** /en/	**O** /əʊ/	**P** /piː/	**Q** /kjuː/	**R** /ɑː/
S /es/	**T** /tiː/	**U** /juː/	**V** /viː/	**W** /ˈdʌbljuː/	**X** /eks/
		Y /waɪ/	**Z** /zed/		

Tip: In British English, Z is **zed** /zed/. In American English, it's *zee* /ziː/.

2 Spell it! Practise the dialogue in pairs. Change the names.

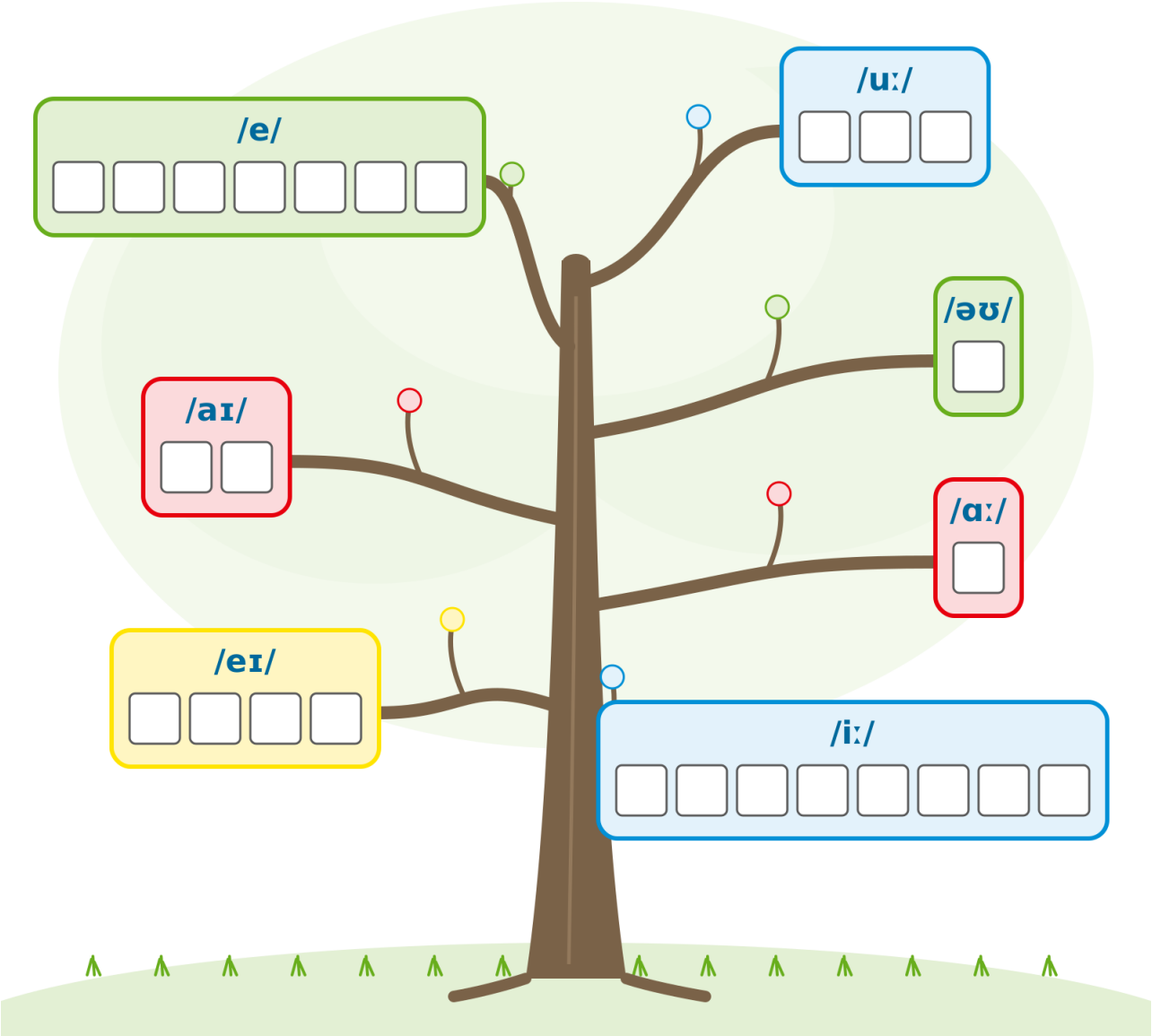
A: *Hi! What's your name?*
B: *María.*
A: *How do you spell your name?*
B: *It's M-A-R-I-A.*
A: *Can you spell your surname, please?*
B: *Sure! / Of course. It's …*
A: *Sorry, is that B or V?*
B: *V, «vee». V for Victory!*

B or V? In Spanish they sound the same; in English they don't! B /biː/ (lips together) · V /viː/ (teeth on your lip).

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3 The Alphabet Tree: write each letter on the right branch.

A B C D E F G H I J K L M N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z



Help: look at the vowel sound in exercise 1: A /eɪ/ goes on the /eɪ/ branch.

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4 Sound detectives: which letter is different?

1	A H E K
2	B F D G
3	I Y R
4	Q U O W
5	M N T S
6	J C A K

5 Spelling toolkit

@	.	_	-	/	LL	A	a	␣
at	dot	underscore	hyphen / dash	slash	double L	capital A	small a	all one word

Useful phrases: *How do you spell that? · Can you say that again, please? · Sorry, is that B or P? · Is that one word or two? · Is it a capital letter? · Let me spell it for you: …*

6 Ask your partner: How do you spell…?

	How do you spell…?	My partner's answer
1	your first name and surname	
2	the name of your town or village	
3	your email address	
4	your street	
5	your favourite series or film	
6	your favourite app	
7	your best friend's name	
8	your favourite singer or band	
9	your pet's name (or your dream pet's name!)	
10	your favourite food	

Challenge: Spell a word from the classroom. Your partner draws it or points to it!

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